News Release
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S&P Global Flash France PMI®

PMI moves closer to levels seen prior to Middle East war outbreak

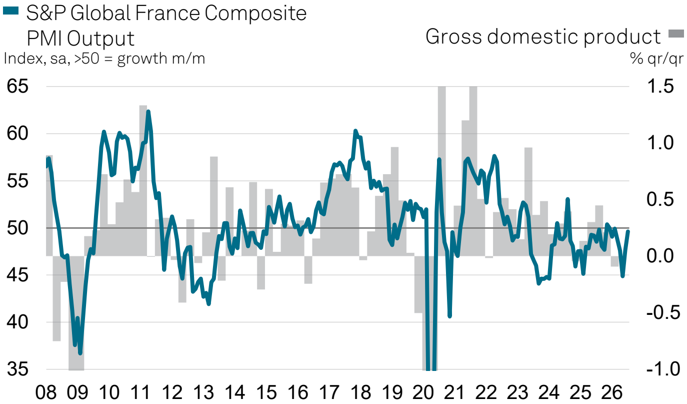
July 2026

Flash France PMI Composite Output Index: 49.6 (Jun: 47.2). 5-month high.

Flash France Services PMI Business Activity Index: 49.8 (Jun: 46.8). 7-month high.

Flash France Manufacturing Output Index: 48.8 (Jun: 49.1). 2-month low.

Flash France Manufacturing PMI: 50.0 (Jun: 51.2). 2-month low.



Data were collected 09-22 July 2026.
Sources: S&P Global PMI, INSEE via S&P Global Market Intelligence. © 2026 S&P Global

The S&P Global 'flash' PMI data portrayed a more stable picture of economic conditions in France during July as the headline index moved closer to the neutral 50.0 threshold. In doing so, it also registered its highest reading since the outbreak of the Middle East war at the end of February. This reversal reflected a broad stabilisation in France's vast services economy – a notable turnaround from the marked contractions witnessed across the second quarter – with demand for services even rising for the first time since November last year. That said, private sector employment remained under pressure and declined again, while business optimism stayed subdued. As for prices, input cost and output price inflation rates eased for the second month in succession.

The headline S&P Global Flash France Composite Output Index – which is based on approximately 80-90% of total survey responses and intended to give an early indication of the final figures – rose again in July, moving up from 47.2 in June to 49.6. Being just below the 50.0 no-change mark, the index signalled only a marginal decline in private sector business activity when compared to the previous month.

Sector-level data revealed a fractionally sharper fall in manufacturing output volumes, with surveyed firms citing weaker demand. Services, on the other hand, saw virtually unchanged activity levels. Relative to the trend in the other months since the Middle East war outbreak, this represented an improvement in performance.

Similarly, the latest survey results were relatively more upbeat on the demand front. A renewed rise in new business at services companies offset a quicker reduction in new manufacturing orders, ending a seven-month spell of deteriorating sales performances across the French private

Comment

Joe Hayes, Senior Principal Economist at S&P Global Market Intelligence:

"While the latest survey data brought with it good news in the form of the France PMI rising further from its May low and inflationary pressures easing, it feels overly optimistic to bank on this momentum continuing given renewed pressures on oil and gas markets in recent days. This also raises the odds of the European Central Bank delivering more monetary policy tightening, which would exacerbate these headwinds.

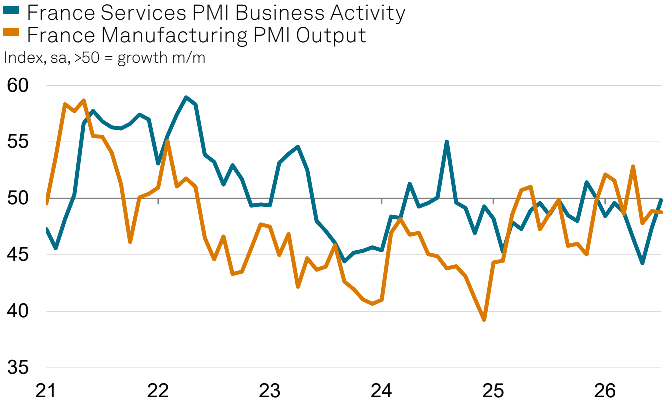
"Escalating tensions between the US and Iran bring fresh uncertainty about inflation, borrowing costs and geopolitics more broadly, and uncertainty has so often been to the detriment of the French economy in recent years."

sector. Latest data also implied that domestic customers provided the impetus to demand, however, as new export business declined sharply and for an eighth month in a row.

There were signs of growing spare capacity across France's private sector in July as backlogs of work decreased for a fourth consecutive survey period. The reduction was broad-based, although services companies registered a far steeper rate of pending order completion than their manufacturing counterparts. Subsequently, surveyed businesses showed a lack of appetite for hiring as the third quarter got underway. For a third month running, private sector employment decreased across the eurozone's second-largest economy.

Job cuts came amid another month of subdued growth expectations. The Future Output Index, which asks firms about their projections for business activity in 12 months' time, ticked up but remained well below its long-term average, signalling weak business confidence in France. Some panel members anticipate a slowdown ahead of the presidential election period next year, while others cited expectations of a continued economic fallout from the Middle East war.

Lastly, inflationary pressures across France eased further during July, marking a sustained cooling from the recent peak in May. Both input costs and output charges rose at softer rates at the start of the third quarter. Of the two monitored sectors, it was manufacturing where inflation remained the most acute.



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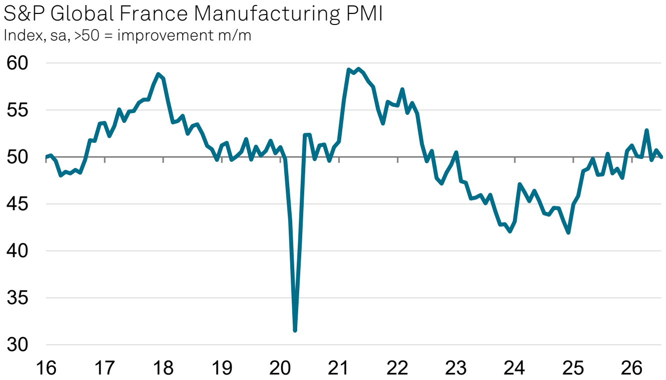

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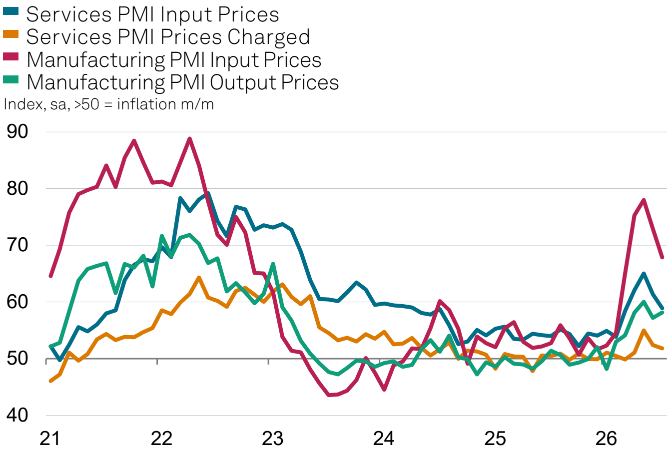

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Methodology

Final July data are published on 3 August for manufacturing and 5 August for services and composite indicators.

The S&P Global Flash France Composite PMI® is compiled by S&P Global from responses to questionnaires sent to survey panels of around 400 manufacturers and 400 service providers. The panels are each stratified by detailed sector and company workforce size, based on contributions to GDP. The services sector is defined as consumer (excluding retail), transport, information, communication, finance, insurance, real estate and business services.

Survey responses are collected in the second half of each month and indicate the direction of change compared to the previous month. The following variables are monitored:

Manufacturing: Output, new orders, new export orders, backlogs of work, stocks of finished goods, employment, quantity of purchases, suppliers' delivery times, stocks of purchases, input prices, output prices, future output.

Services: Business activity, new business, new export business, outstanding business, employment, input prices, prices charged, future activity.

A diffusion index is calculated for each manufacturing and services variable. The index is the sum of the percentage of 'higher' responses and half the percentage of 'unchanged' responses. The indices vary between 0 and 100, with a reading above 50 indicating an overall increase compared to the previous month, and below 50 an overall decrease. The indices are then seasonally adjusted.

Composite indices for are calculated by weighting together comparable manufacturing and services indices using official manufacturing and services annual value added.

The headline figure is the Composite Output Index. This is a weighted average of the Manufacturing Output Index and the Services Business Activity Index. It may be referred to as the 'Composite PMI' but is not comparable with the headline Manufacturing PMI, which is a weighted average of five manufacturing indices (including the Manufacturing Output Index).

The headline manufacturing figure is the Manufacturing Purchasing Managers' Index™ (PMI®). The PMI is a weighted average of the following five indices: New Orders (30%), Output (25%), Employment (20%), Suppliers' Delivery Times (15%) and Stocks of Purchases (10%). For the PMI calculation the Suppliers' Delivery Times Index is inverted so that it moves in a comparable direction to the other indices.

The headline services figure is the Services Business Activity Index. This is a diffusion index calculated from a single question that asks for changes in the volume of business activity compared with one month previously. The Business Activity Index is comparable to the Manufacturing Output Index. It may be referred to as the 'Services PMI' but is not comparable with the headline Manufacturing PMI.

Flash data are calculated from around 80-90% of total responses and are intended to provide an accurate early indication of the final data. Since flash data were first processed, the average differences between final and flash index values for the headline indices are:

Composite Output Index = 0.0 (absolute difference 0.4)

Services Business Activity Index = -0.1 (absolute difference 0.5)

Manufacturing PMI = 0.1 (absolute difference 0.3)

S&P Global do not revise underlying survey data after first publication, but seasonal adjustment factors may be revised from time to time as appropriate which will affect the seasonally adjusted data series. Historical data relating to the underlying (unadjusted) numbers, first published seasonally adjusted series and subsequently revised data are available to subscribers from S&P Global.

For further information on the PMI survey methodology, please contact economics@spglobal.com.

S&P Global

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PMI by S&P Global

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